

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Penny Pincher

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

- Asks **Hugh Bidder** for auction previews and always disputes his estimates.
- Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.
- Has compared auction finds with **Tess Tament**. Penny prefers a bargain **Tess** has overlooked.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Penny Pincher

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Your other secret

You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she remembers the decorative object from your family.
- Ask Saul D. Bid how old private sales can be traced. If he is absent, try Hugh Bidder.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1** *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*
- 2** *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*
- 3** *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I brought the family letters. They show that we contested the sale Grant called perfectly voluntary. I intended to confront him. He valued the object generously when displaying it and remembered its purchase price with astonishing modesty. I can recognize a bargain without mistaking it for justice.

IF MURDERER

The family letters contradict Grant's story. He offered to buy them too, as if purchasing the evidence would improve the sale. I wanted our object back. He wanted another invoice proving that people with less money had agreed to his version of events.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took Grant the family letters with a red mark across their cover sheet. Their account of the disputed sale would embarrass my family too. He offered to buy the letters. I asked whether the price included the right to stop reading them. I left the service table afterward. That was the only time I visited it before he drank.

IF MURDERER

I brought a working carbon of the family letters' cover sheet to the private service station. It carried a red mark across its fold. The disputed sale included facts my family would rather not advertise. Grant offered to buy the letters themselves. I asked whether the price included the right to stop reading them.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Penny Pincher

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The original cover sheet has raised RECEIVED letters. The clerk embossed it in front of me; I made sure the impression missed my grandmother's handwriting, then carried the letters to Grant. The receipt acknowledges the papers. It does not sell them.

IF MURDERER

I corrected the sale date in red pencil on the carbon cover sheet I gave Grant. The clerk embossed the original afterward. My grandmother's letters explain why that date matters. Grant offered to buy the evidence of the disputed sale along with the silence he expected to accompany it.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Penny Pincher

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The letters disclose a disputed sale and my family's part in it. I withheld some of them because I wanted a cleaner family story. I waited for the cover sheet's RECEIVED embossing before my only service visit. That seal began after the glass cover closed. Concealing an uncomfortable history did not give that visit access to the glass's interior.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the tour and concealed it in the letters' handling cloth. I brought the correspondence to Grant while the glass was uncovered and coated his glass. The glass cover sealed it until the pour. I killed him over a family claim and then hid behind letters that deserved a better advocate.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.